THE CORPORATION OF THE CITY OF VAUGHAN

REQUEST FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

(RFEOI)

COVER PAGE

RFEOI NO:	RFEOI25-466
RFEOI NAME:	**AI for Planning Applications**
CLOSING TIME:	**3:00:00 p.m. LOCAL TIME on May 19, 2026**
DEADLINE FOR QUESTIONS:	**3:00:00 p.m. LOCAL TIME on May 5, 2026**
Procurement Services Department representative for this RFEOI ("PR"):	Name: Sia Xilias Title: Procurement Category Specialist Email address: sia.xilias@vaughan.ca

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THE CITY WILL ONLY ACCEPT RESPONSES UPLOADED ELECTRONICALLY TO THE CITY'S ONLINE BIDDING SYSTEM at https://vaughan.bidsandtenders.ca

Respondents who require accommodations due to a disability should contact the PR or call the Procurement Services main line at 905-832-8555.

Late Responses will not be accepted.

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The following definitions apply to the interpretation of the RFEOI;

"**Addenda"** or **"Addendum**" refers to an addition or change to the RFEOI issued in writing by the Owner prior to the Closing Time.

"Business Day" means any day from Monday through Friday between the hours of 8:30am and 4:30pm, excluding statutory holidays observed by the Owner.

"City" and **"Owner"** means The Corporation of the City of Vaughan.

"**Closing Time**" is identified on the Cover Page.

"Local Time" refers to the official time in the City of Toronto

"Respondent" means the legal entity or entities submitting a response to this RFEOI (a "**Submission**").

"RFEOI" means this Request for Expression of Interest document, including all appendices, and any Addenda.

"Work" means all goods and services described in the RFEOI Terms of Reference.

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KEY DETAILS

1. List of Appendices

Appendix A – Terms of Reference

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2. Other:

In the event of conflict between the provisions in this RFEOI and the provisions in the Bidding System Terms of Use and/or the Vendor Guide to the Bidding System, the terms in the RFEOI shall prevail.

1. INTENT OF RFEOI

This RFEOI is issued by the Corporation of the City of Vaughan ("City") for the purpose of gathering information.

This RFEOI does not result in any commitment by the Owner to purchase any Work from any Respondent at any time.

2. CONTENTS OF RFEOI

Respondents should inform the PR utilizing the "Submit Question" feature in City's Bidding System™ should any Prequalification Documents be missing or incomplete and/or upon finding any discrepancies or omissions.

While the Owner has used considerable effort to ensure an accurate representation of the information in this RFEOI, the contents are not necessarily comprehensive or exhaustive, and the Owner will not be liable for any errors or omissions in any part of this RFEOI.

3. ENQUIRIES & ADDENDUM

All enquiries concerning this RFEOI, including specifications, process and results are to be submitted through the "Submit Question" feature on City's Bidding System. Emailed enquiries will not be responded to by the City.

If any Respondent requires an accommodation due to a disability, requests should be directed to the City's PR referenced above.

The City shall not be responsible for responding to questions or reviewing communications that are posed by any other method.

Respondents and their representatives are not permitted to contact any employees, officers, agents, elected or appointed officials, or other representatives of the City, other than in accordance with this section or as otherwise expressly permitted by this RFEOI or requested by City. Failure to adhere to this rule may result in the disqualification of the Respondent and the rejection of the Submission.

It shall be the Respondent's responsibility to advise the Procurement Services Representative in writing if Respondent feels that any language, requirement, specification, etc., or any combination thereof, inadvertently restricts or limits the requirements stated in this document to a single source. Such notification must be received no later than seven (7) Calendar Days prior to Closing Time.

A transcript of the questions received before the Deadline for Questions and corresponding answers will be made available on City's Bidding System via an Addendum.

Any modification or clarification will be by written Addendum only issued by the City. The Addendum(s) will form part of the RFEOI.

Questions received after the official question submission deadline will be reviewed and answered based at the sole discretion of the Owner, and if answered, may or may not be made available on City's Bidding System via an Addendum.

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4. E- SUBMISSIONS PROCEDURE

6.1 The City will ONLY accept RFEOI Submissions uploaded electronically to the City's Bidding System. Respondents who require accommodations due to a disability should contact the Procurement Services main line at 905-832-8555. If you have problems uploading your RFEOI Submission, please contact the City's Procurement Services Department main line.

6.2 The City's Bidding System Terms of Use Agreement forms part of this RFEOI. RFEOI Submissions submitted and/or received by any other method shall be rejected, unless the City has instructed otherwise by published Addendum or a special exception has been granted by the City's Director of Procurement Services.

6.3 A RFEOI Submission will only be considered to have been submitted once it has been received by the City in its Bidding System. The time the RFEOI Submission is received shall be determined by the City's Bidding System web clock.

6.4 The Bidding System will send a confirmation email to the Respondent advising that its RFEOI Submission was submitted successfully. If you do not receive a confirmation email, contact the City's Procurement Services Dept.

6.5 Respondents should not consider their RFEOI Submission to have been submitted until they have received the confirmation e-mail (oral confirmation will not suffice).

6.6 Respondents are cautioned that the time the RFEOI Submission is received is based on when the RFEOI Submission is RECEIVED by the Bidding System, not when a RFEOI Submission is sent for transmission by a Respondent and not when Respondent system indicates Respondent uploaded/sent/transmitted the RFEOI Submission, as RFEOI Submission transmission can be delayed in an "Internet Traffic Jam" due to file transfer size, transmission speed, etc. Accordingly, the City recommends that Respondents allow sufficient time to upload their RFEOI Submission and attachment(s) (if applicable) and to resolve any issues that may arise.

6.7 RFEOI Submissions must be received by the Bidding System before the stipulated Closing Time. Late RFEOI Submissions will not be accepted by the Bidding System.

6.8 To ensure receipt of the latest information (and updates via email) regarding this procurement opportunity, or if a Respondent has obtained the RFEOI from a third party, the onus is on the Respondent to create a Bidding System Vendor account and register as a 'Plan Taker' for this RFEOI at http://vaughan.bidsandtenders.ca/

6.9 All RFEOI Submissions are subject to the terms and conditions of this RFEOI and by submitting a RFEOI Submission, Respondents agree to the terms and conditions herein.

4.1 Company Contacts - Regarding having multiple company contacts on the online Vendor account:

i. Do not invite any additional contacts that you do not want to have access to view, edit, submit and/or withdraw or who may be in direct competition for example (a company may have two divisions that could compete for the same RFEOI Submission opportunity).

ii. It is recommended that when creating or updating a Bidding System Vendor account to add additional company contacts to create their own login to the Bidding System. This will permit your invited contacts that have created their

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own login to manage (register, submit, edit and withdraw) RFEOI Submissions which your company is a Registered Plan Taker for.

iii. Vendor contacts may: act on vendor's behalf, receive Addendum notifications from the Bidding System, submit RFEOI Submissions electronically through the Bidding System, withdraw and/or edit and/or acknowledge Addendum/Addenda, on behalf of vendor.

iv. If you are an invited company contact it is required that you create your login from the link contained in the email invitation. Do NOT create a separate vendor account.

4.2 Uploading Documents into the Bidding System

To upload a document:

i. Click on the "Browse" button to locate the file/folder on your computer or network
ii. Click on the "Upload" button.

iii. After the file/folder has been successfully uploaded, a link to the document will appear on the screen, along with the date and time that it was uploaded.

iv. If you need to remove an uploaded document, click on the "Remove" button next to the document name.

v. Documents being uploaded should:

1. be in Adobe pdf format or other format requested by the City; and
2. NOT have a security password.

vi. It is the Respondent's sole responsibly to ensure that their uploaded document(s):

1. are not defective, corrupted or blank; and
2. can be opened and viewed by the City.

The City may reject or disqualify any RFEOI Submission that contains documents that cannot be opened and verified by the City.

Respondents may only upload one (1) file/folder for each required

document. The maximum single file/folder upload size is 500 MB.

To reduce the size of a single file/folder, or to combine multiple files into a single folder for upload, Respondents should compress (zip) their file(s)/folder(s) as described below.

4.3 Compressing Zip Folders

i. To compress (zip) a single file or folder:

ii. Locate the file/folder that you wish to compress (zip)

- then right-click on the file/folder
- select "Send to"
- then click on "Compressed (zipped) folder"

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iii. new compressed (zipped) folder will be created in the same location as the original file.

iv. To rename the compressed (zipped) folder, right-click on it, click on “Rename” and enter the new name.

v. To compress (zip) multiple files into a single folder:

1. Locate and select the files/folders that you wish to combine
2. With all of the files selected, right-click, select “Send to”, then click on “Compressed (zipped) folder”.

vi. A new compressed (zipped) folder will be created in the same location as the original files.

vii.

viii. To rename the compressed (zipped) folder, right-click on it, click on “Rename” and enter the new name.

ix. If you are uploading a compressed (zipped) folder containing more than one (1) document, please ensure that each document is named appropriately.

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5. FREEDOM OF INFORMATION

In accordance with the *Municipal Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act* (“**MFIPPA**”), any personal information Respondents provide in submitting a Submission is collected under the authority of the Municipal Act (Ontario) and will be used exclusively in the Proposal review process.

All Submissions and associated documentation submitted become the property of the Owner upon receipt.

Pursuant to MFIPPA, the Owner may be required to disclose any such information in response to an access request.

To assist Owner in responding to an access request, Respondents are advised to identify in their Submissions any specific scientific, technical, commercial, proprietary, or similar confidential information, and explain why the disclosure of such information would cause them harm. Complete Submissions are not to be identified as confidential.

6. CONFLICT OF INTEREST

Each Respondent must declare in their submission any situation that may be a conflict of interest or that may appear as a potential conflict of interest in submitting a response or undertaking the service. If a conflict of interest does exist, the Owner may, at its discretion, refuse to consider all or portions of the submission.

1. PROCESS TYPE AND INTERPRETATION

Respondents are advised that by submitting a response to this RFEOI that they acknowledge and accept the following:

(a) This RFEOI process is not intended to create a formal, legally binding bidding process and shall not give rise to the legal rights and duties applied to a formal Contract A binding bidding process or any other legal obligations arising out of any tendering process contract or collateral contract, and instead shall be governed by the common law applicable to direct negotiations;

(b) No legal obligation regarding the procurement of the Deliverables will be created between the Respondent and the Owner by this RFEOI process;

(c) The Respondent may withdraw its Response at any time during the RFEOI process, and Submissions become Owner property until withdrawn;

(d) The Owner may cancel this RFEOI process at any time; and

(e) Neither party shall have the right to make any claims (in contract, tort, or otherwise) against the other with respect to to the selection of Respondents, a decision to reject a Submission or disqualify a Respondent, or a decision of the Respondent to withdraw its Response.

For greater certainty, City is not under any obligation to:

- issue a subsequent tender or any other documentation related to the Deliverables;
- initiate any further bid process related to the Deliverables, or
- award a contract for the Deliverables.

The Owner, its elected officials, employees and agents will not be responsible for any liabilities, costs, expenses, loss or damage incurred, sustained or suffered by any Respondents at any time related to any delay in the RFEOI Schedule, or Owner exercising its rights under this Section.

Should a dispute arise from the terms and conditions outlined herein, regarding meaning, intent or ambiguity, the decision of the Owner shall be final.

The provisions in each RFEOI Document are in addition to and supplement the provisions in the other Documents.

All rights and remedies of City under this RFEOI shall be cumulative and none shall exclude any other rights or remedies allowed by law.

The headings within an RFEOI Document are for convenience and reference only and shall not affect or be used to interpret the provisions therein.

The waiver by City of any provision of this RFEOI shall only be effective in writing and shall not operate or be construed as a waive of any subsequent breach.

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Please find below a preview only of certain schedules (collectively, “Schedules”) that will need to be completed online only through the Bidding System by Respondents as part of their RFEOI Submission.

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